the 1990 crisis. Such restraint, as Subrahmanyam cogently argues, stemmed from India's knowledge of the existence of an incipient Pakistani nuclear weapons program.

S. PAUL KAPUR

Optimistic analysts believe that the 1990 crisis demonstrates nuclear weapons' pacifying effects on the South Asian security environment. Specifically, they argue that, in the absence of nuclear deterrence, India would most likely have attacked Pakistan and triggered a large-scale conflict in 1990.[35] In fact, multiple factors probably contributed to the standoff's peaceful resolution. Outside intervention such as the Gates mission may have helped.[36] Discussions between the Indian and Pakistani foreign ministers in the United States in late April may also have reduced tensions.[37]

But what of the optimists' claim that nuclear deterrence prevented an Indian attack during the 1990 crisis? Deterrence requires a potential aggressor to want to attack another party and to decide not to do so out of fear of costly retaliation. A state that did not actually wish to attack another cannot be said to have been deterred from doing so.[38] Close examination indicates that the Indian government never seriously considered attacking Pakistan during the 1990 crisis. The standoff's peaceful resolution therefore should not be attributed to Pakistani deterrence.

Even at the height of the 1990 crisis, it does not appear that India was undertaking any military action to prepare for a strike against Pakistan. Indeed, Indian and Pakistani deployments suggest a lack of hostile intent on the part of either party. In Kashmir, Punjab, and Rajasthan, India and Pakistan together possessed a total of four armored divisions. Only one Indian division, at the firing range in Rajasthan, was outside of its peacetime station, and no Indian or Pakistani units moved toward the international border during the crisis.[39] American military attachés in India and Pakistan had broad access to both sides' forces and did not view deployments during the crisis as being unusual or particularly provocative.[40]